

Unexplained Respiratory Illness in Queensland – Public Update

The Australian Government Department of Health and Aged Care, in coordination with Queensland Health, is actively investigating an unexplained respiratory illness outbreak affecting a nursing home in Kelvin Grove, Brisbane.

Key Updates:

- Three confirmed fatalities linked to the nursing home outbreak (ages 78, 82, and 84, all with pre-existing conditions).
- No confirmed causative pathogen at this time; testing remains ongoing.
- A separate cluster involving a family in Fairfield continues to be investigated.
- No widespread transmission detected outside of the affected groups.
- Current Public Health Actions:
 - Enhanced hospital surveillance for similar respiratory illnesses.
 - Contact tracing and monitoring of identified individuals.
 - Increased infection control measures in aged care and healthcare settings.
 - Additional laboratory testing, including genomic sequencing, to determine a possible causative agent.

What You Should Do:

- If you experience fever, difficulty breathing, or persistent cough, seek medical advice and limit contact with others.
- Aged care residents and staff should remain alert for symptoms and report any new cases promptly.
- Follow standard infection prevention measures, including hand hygiene and wearing a mask if unwell.
- There is no need for public alarm; however, those at higher risk should take extra precautions.

Next Steps & Further Information:

Authorities will continue to update the public regularly as more information becomes available. The situation is being closely monitored, and any new public health recommendations will be issued accordingly.